

Chapter 143-1

Greedy—what a terrifying word.

She had originally thought herself free of desires and wants, able to live even without love.

Yet now she was pressing closer step by step, wanting her love.

Even less love wouldn't do.

Xu Qingzhu's voice was very low, breathily murmuring an entire sentence—ambiguous and tender.

But Liang Shi was still lost in their earlier deep kiss, her consciousness hazy. She couldn't pull herself out for the moment, nor did she hear what Xu Qingzhu said.

By the time she thought to ask, Xu Qingzhu had already stopped speaking and was instead nibbling on her earlobe.

Cool fingertips wreaked havoc on Liang Shi's glands. The rich tea fragrance of Baihao Yinzen¹ spread throughout the car. Liang Shi wrapped her arm around her waist and negotiated in a low voice: "Stop messing around. Tonight."

"We agreed there'd be no messing around tonight." Xu Qingzhu said.

Liang Shi: "..."

These past few days, they seemed to have been breaking their agreements in perfect unspoken accord.

Clearly thinking they absolutely wouldn't do it again, yet always breaking that resolve time after time.

It was indeed quite pleasurable.

Liang Shi asked her: "So you're not going to work anymore?"

"I can skip it." Xu Qingzhu answered, her voice hoarse.

"We're still outside." Liang Shi said, then paused: "Xu Qingzhu, is your heat period not over yet?"

These words seemed to have touched some sensitive nerve in Xu Qingzhu. As if a spring had been pressed on her body, she immediately sat up and moved to the car seat.

Not looking the slightest bit like someone lost in passion.

The atmosphere in the car instantly turned cold, the romantic feeling gone without a trace.

That scorching kiss from just moments ago seemed like it had all been Liang Shi's imagination.

"I..." Liang Shi pressed her lips together, asking somewhat at a loss: "Did I say something wrong?"

Xu Qingzhu straightened her slightly disheveled clothes, fished out the cup of milk tea from under the car seat, took a straw from the bag, and calmly poked it through.

Pop!

A very loud sound.

Xu Qingzhu took a sip of the milk tea. The tapioca pearls at the bottom were very sticky, and the taste was mediocre.

"No." Xu Qingzhu's expression was bland: "I just felt like drinking milk tea."

She seemed like a completely different person from the one who had just been sitting on Liang Shi's lap, passionately kissing her.

That kiss just now had been so scorching it had nearly melted Liang Shi. If not for a thread of rationality remaining, Liang Shi would definitely have done something reckless with her right there in the car.

But out of consideration for the things she still had to handle this afternoon, she had put on the brakes in time.

And now Xu Qingzhu had withdrawn so quickly. The way she sat with lowered eyes drinking milk tea didn't look at all like someone who had just experienced arousal. Yet when asked, she insisted she wasn't angry.

Liang Shi didn't know what to do and could only wait quietly.

The sound of Xu Qingzhu sipping her milk tea was very soft, but in the quiet car, it was clearly audible.

She could even hear the sound of her chewing the tapioca pearls distinctly, as well as the sound of her throat swallowing.

This was a form of torture.

After a while, Liang Shi asked her softly again: "Xu Qingzhu, did something troubling happen at work?"

Because she felt Xu Qingzhu was angry, Liang Shi didn't dare use those intimate terms of address. Even calling her "Xu Qingzhu" was done with great care.

Xu Qingzhu shook her head: "No, everything is going smoothly."

There were even plans to acquire a small company.

"Then..." Liang Shi couldn't think of what else might have made her angry. After a long pause, she still couldn't say anything.

Footnotes:

¹ **Baihao Yinzhen** (白毫銀針): Also known as "Silver Needle White Tea," this is one of the most prized and expensive Chinese white teas. It's made only from the unopened buds of the tea plant, which are covered in fine silvery-white hairs (白毫). The tea has a delicate, sweet flavor with subtle floral notes. In this ABO universe, it's Liang Shi's pheromone scent.